

P0-5 Walkthrough — Create the Firebase project

SECTION 06-operations-it

TYPE setup-guide

STATUS

active

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Goal: create the managed cloud project that hosts the Fly GACA PWA, database, auth and Cloud Functions.

The one irreversible decision here is the Firestore region. Get it right the first time.

1. Create the project

- Go to console.firebase.google.com and sign in with the Google account that should own the project — use a project-dedicated account rather than a personal one if you can.
- Add a project; name it (for example `flygaca` or `fly-gaca-prod`). Note the generated **Project ID** — record it in `../phase0.md`.

2. Set the Cloud Firestore region — me-central2 (Dammam)

- In **Build** → **Firestore Database**, create the database.
- Choose location **me-central2** (Dammam, Saudi Arabia). **This is permanent — the location cannot be changed after the database is created.** me-central2 keeps data inside the Kingdom, which supports PDPL data-sovereignty.
- Start in production mode; the strict per-user security rules are written in Phase 3.

3. Enable the other services

- **Authentication** — enable it; sign-in providers are configured in Phase 3.
- **App Check** — register it; enforcement comes in Phase 2/3.
- **Hosting** — enable it; this is the Phase 1 deploy target for the static PWA.

4. Upgrade to the Blaze plan

- Cloud Functions (Phase 2) require the Blaze pay-as-you-go plan. Upgrade now and set a **budget alert** so there are no surprises.

5. Verify AI inference data-residency

- Before Phase 2, confirm where Gemini / Vertex AI inference runs and whether it meets your data-sovereignty posture. This is an open item in the briefing's hosting section — record the answer.

6. Record the result

- Update `../phase0.md` P0-5 with the Project ID and the confirmed Firestore region.